

Which Organizer, When?

Unit 7 · Tennessee State & Local Government (GC.28–GC.30)

Match the task to the tool —
then teach the *why*.

Students don't need more worksheets — they need the **right thinking tool** for the task in front of them. Find the *verb* in the assignment, then reach for the organizer built for that kind of thinking.

45-minute class? Plan **one** deep organizer (~20 min) or **two** quick ones (~10 min each), plus warm-up & discussion. Every page prints its own time estimate.

WHEN THE TASK ASKS STUDENTS TO...	REACH FOR	≈ TIME	BECAUSE IT WORKS
Compare two things	● Venn diagram · T-chart	10–15 MIN	The overlap makes shared traits visible and sharpens the differences. <i>Marzano's #1 strategy.</i>
Compare three or more on set criteria	● Comparison matrix	15–20 MIN	Holds many cases against the same yardstick so patterns pop.
Trace causes & effects	● Cause & Effect	15–20 MIN	Makes the chain of “why it happened” visible. <i>Builds SSP.05.</i>
Put steps in order / show a process	● Timeline · Sequence	15–20 MIN	Sequence exposes how one step makes the next possible. <i>Builds SSP.05.</i>
Brainstorm & connect ideas	● Concept web	10–15 MIN	Surfaces prior knowledge and shows how ideas link to one hub.
Summarize — find the main point	● Main Idea & Details	10–15 MIN	Separates the big idea from the details that support it.
Activate prior knowledge & track learning	● K-W-L chart	10–15 MIN	Sets a purpose and makes thinking metacognitive. <i>UDL self-regulation.</i>
Learn a key term	● Frayer model	10–15 MIN	Builds deep word knowledge — not a definition students forget by Friday.
Analyze a source	● HIPPO	15–20 MIN	Gives students a historian's routine for interrogating a document.
Make an evidence-based claim	● C-E-R	20–25 MIN	Turns an opinion into a defensible argument: claim, evidence, reasoning.
Weigh two sides or options	● T-chart · Problem–Solution	15–20 MIN	Forces a decision that rests on evidence from both sides.
Get the basics of an event	● 5 Ws	5–10 MIN	Fast, complete factual capture — who, what, when, where, why.
Connect the nation to Tennessee	★ Tennessee Connection	10–15 MIN	Local ties make national civics stick — and it's what sets Government Hack apart. Our signature move.

Social Studies Practices Crosswalk

Unit 7 · Tennessee State & Local Government (SSP.01–SSP.06)

*Every organizer doubles as a
skills tool.*

The Tennessee **Social Studies Practices (SSP.01–06)** are the skills every unit must build. This crosswalk maps each practice to the organizers that develop it — and shows **where** it lives in Unit 7 — so a graphic organizer is never busywork: it is deliberate practice toward a standard.

PRACTICE	WHAT STUDENTS DO (TN SSP)	ORGANIZERS THAT BUILD IT	WHERE IN UNIT 7
● SSP.01	Collect data & information from a variety of primary and secondary sources.	Comparison Matrix · 5 Ws · K-W-L	GC.28 Tennessee's three branches (Matrix, branch × function).
● SSP.02	Critically examine a source: purpose, point of view, evidence vs. assertion, bias.	HIPPO · Comparison Matrix	GC.29 local-government types (Matrix, type × trait); HIPPO on a constitution clause.
● SSP.03	Synthesize data from several sources; compare accounts; frame new questions.	Comparison Matrix · Concept Web · Venn	GC.28 & GC.29 compare branches, courts, and local-government types.
● SSP.04	Construct & communicate arguments citing supporting evidence.	C-E-R · T-Chart · Problem–Solution	GC.29 opinion piece on civic participation (C-E-R).
● SSP.05	Develop historical awareness: cause, context, continuity & change over time.	Timeline · Cause & Effect · Sequence	How Tennessee's Grand Divisions and consolidated metro governments took shape over time.
● SSP.06	Develop geographic awareness: patterns and scale from local to national.	★ Tennessee Connection · Lookup · Matrix	GC.30 identify your own governor, senator, and representative by district (Lookup); GC.29 your county on the map.

Venn Diagram — Compare Two

⌚ 10-15 min

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

Venn · Compare Two

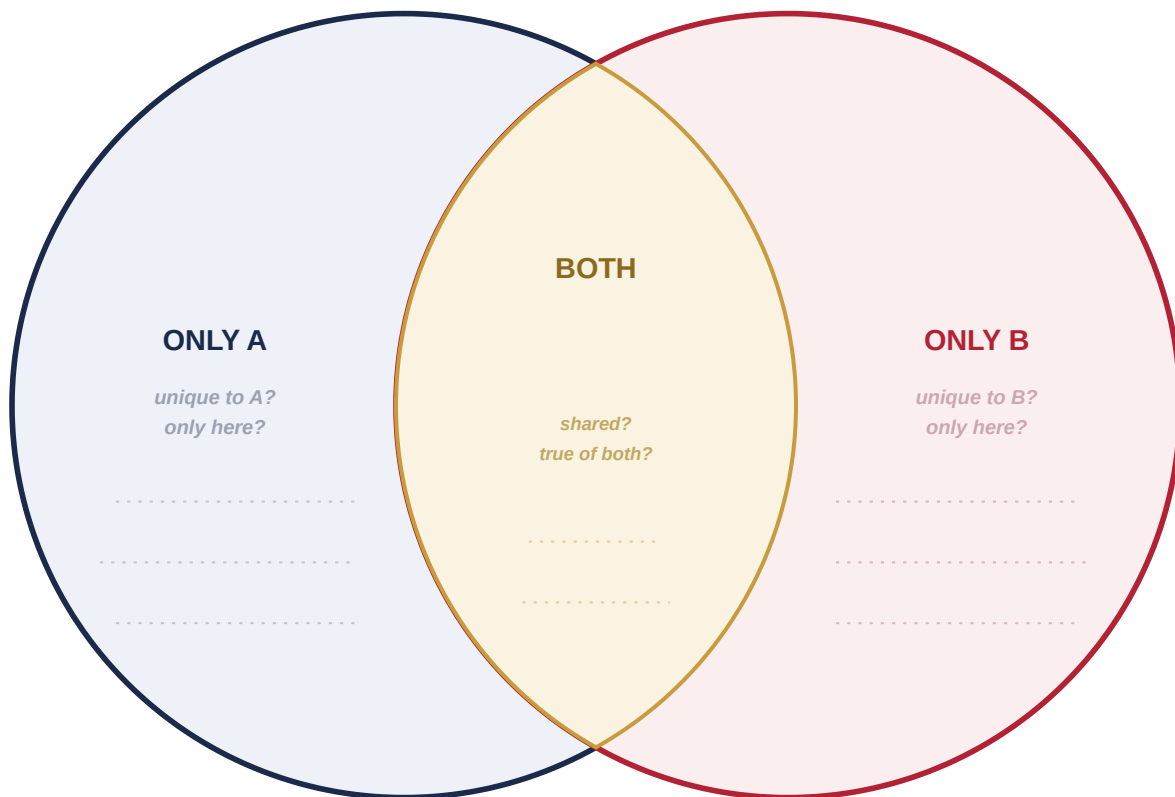
Marzano #1

WHEN · WHY Reach for a Venn when students compare **two** things: the overlap makes shared traits visible and sharpens the differences. *Identifying similarities & differences is Marzano's highest-yield strategy.*

Write what makes each unique in its own circle — and what they share in the middle.

Topic A: _____
write in the left circle

Topic B: _____
write in the right circle



MAKE IT WORK FOR EVERY STUDENT UDL · MTSS

SCAFFOLD

Give a word bank of traits to sort into the three regions before writing.

EXTEND

Use the overlap to write one sentence explaining what the two share at a deeper level.

SHOW IT YOUR WAY

Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw**, or **build** their response.

Venn Diagram — Compare Three

⌚ 15-20 min

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

Venn · Compare Three

Synthesis

WHEN · WHY Use a three-circle Venn to compare **three** things at once and find what any two — or all three — share.
Synthesizing across sources builds TN Practice SSP.03.

Place each example in the right region. What belongs to one, to a pair, or to all three?

● **Topic 1**

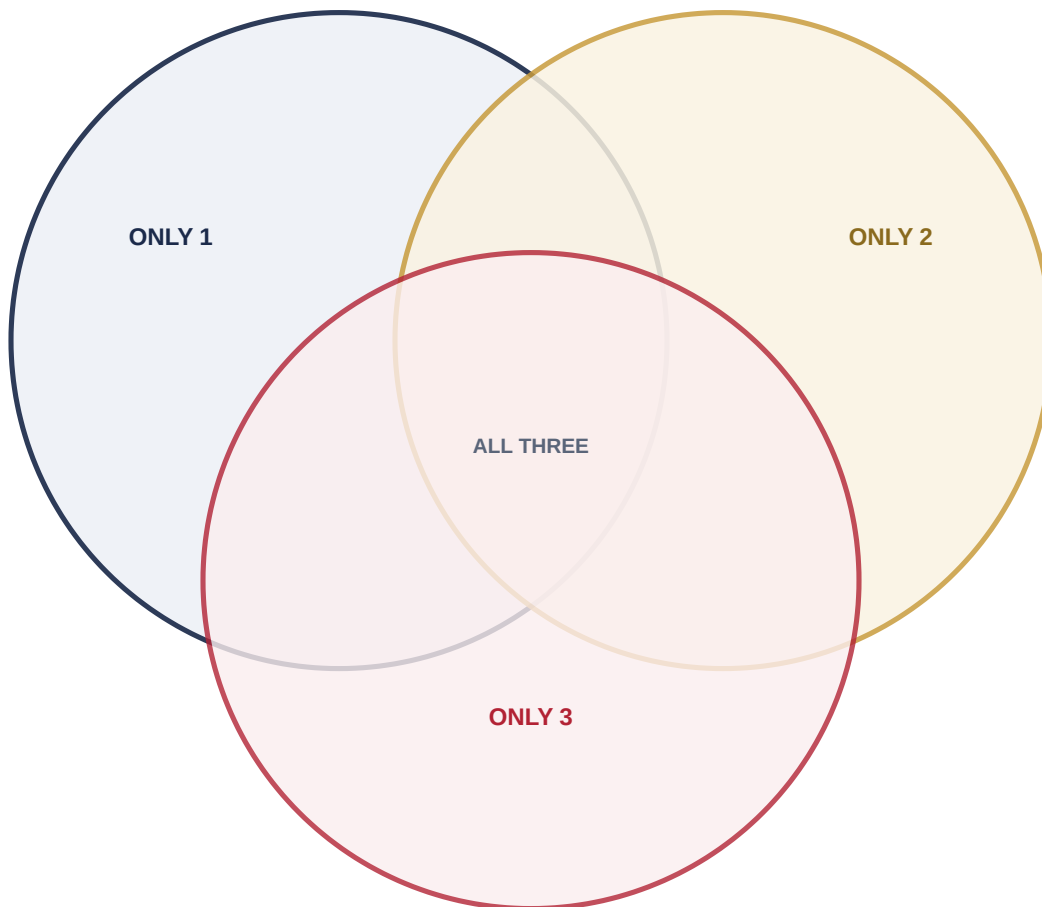
write examples in the circle

● **Topic 2**

write examples in the circle

● **Topic 3**

write examples in the circle



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SCAFFOLD

Start by placing three sure examples — one clearly in each 'only' region — then work toward the overlaps.

EXTEND

Explain why the center region (all three) is the hardest to fill — what must be true there?

SHOW IT YOUR WAY

Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw**, or **build** their response.

T-Chart · Two Sides

DOK 2–3

Gather evidence on each side — then use the bottom line to decide.

WHEN · WHY When students compare **three or more** cases against the same criteria, a matrix holds them to one yardstick so patterns pop. *Structured comparison is Marzano's highest-yield move.*

Fill each cell, then read down each column and across each row for patterns.

	Case 1 name it	Case 2 name it	Case 3 name it
Criterion A			
Criterion B			
Criterion C			
PATTERN	What pattern do you see across the cases? _____		

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SCAFFOLD
Fill one full row together so students see how to compare across the same criterion.

EXTEND
Add a fourth case or a fourth criterion and predict where it would fall.

SHOW IT YOUR WAY
Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw**, or **build** their response.

Cause & Effect

⌚ 15-20 min

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

Cause & Effect

SSP.05

WHEN · WHY Trace the chain of **why** something happened and what followed. *Cause-and-effect reasoning builds TN Practice SSP.05.*

List what led up to the event on the left; list what it set in motion on the right.

CAUSES

WHAT CONDITIONS MADE IT HAPPEN?

EFFECTS

WHAT DID IT LEAD TO?

THE EVENT
name it

So what? Which single cause mattered most, and why?

MAKE IT WORK FOR EVERY STUDENT UDL · MTSS**SCAFFOLD**

Provide two causes and two effects on cards; students place and then add one of each.

EXTEND

Draw an arrow from one effect to a new cause: how did one result trigger the next?

SHOW IT YOUR WAY

Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw**, or **build** their response.

Timeline — Change Over Time

⌚ 15-20 min

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

Timeline

SSP.05 Chronology

WHEN · WHY Put events **in order** to expose how one step made the next possible. *Chronological reasoning is TN Practice SSP.05.*

Write each date on the left, then explain why the event mattered.

Event 1 — what happened?

write the date

Event 2 — what happened?

Event 3 — what happened?

Event 4 — why did it matter?

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SCAFFOLD

Give the events on cards; students order them on the spine first, then add significance.

EXTEND

Add arrows between nodes to show cause & effect across the sequence.

SHOW IT YOUR WAY

Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw**, or **build** their response.

Concept Web

⌚ 10-15 min

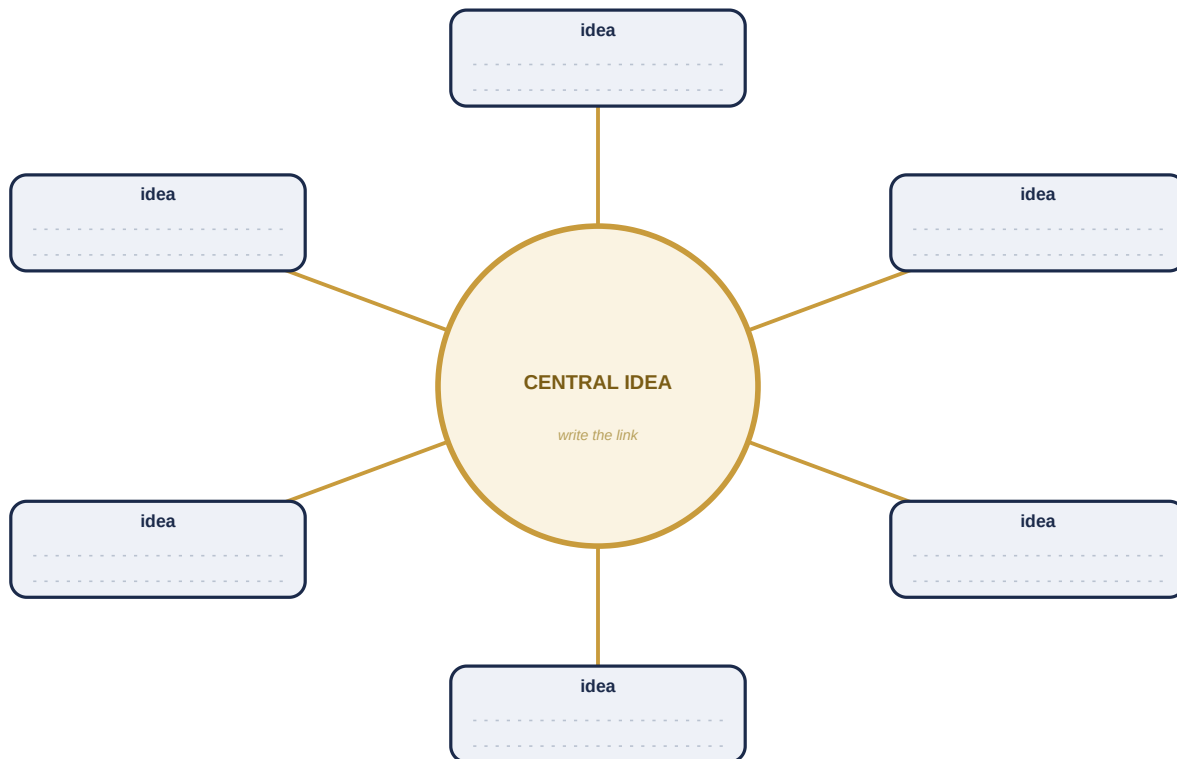
Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

Concept Web

Schema

WHEN · WHY **Brainstorm** and connect ideas around one central concept — it surfaces prior knowledge and shows how ideas link to a hub. *Building schema is a UDL comprehension support.*

Write the central idea in the hub, then fill each bubble with a connected idea — and name the link.



MAKE IT WORK FOR EVERY STUDENT UDL · MTSS

SCAFFOLD

Fill two bubbles together and model naming the link on the connecting line.

EXTEND

Draw a line between two outer bubbles that connect to each other, not just to the hub.

SHOW IT YOUR WAY

Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw**, or **build** their response.

Main Idea & Details

⌚ 10-15 min

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

Main Idea & Details

Summarize

WHEN · WHY Summarize by separating the big idea from the details that support it. *Distinguishing central idea from detail is core disciplinary literacy (SSP.02).*

Write the main idea on top; add supporting details below; then sum it up in one line.

MAIN IDEA

▼

Detail

EVIDENCE

▼

Detail

EVIDENCE

▼

Detail

EVIDENCE

In one sentence: the main idea matters because _____

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SCAFFOLD
Give the main idea and have students hunt only for the supporting details.

EXTEND
Rank the details from strongest to weakest support and justify the top one.

SHOW IT YOUR WAY
Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw**, or **build** their response.

Fill K and W before you start; return to L after the lesson.

[illegible]

UDL · MTSS

Offer sentence starters: 'I already know...', 'I want to know...', 'I learned...'.

In the L column, note one thing you still wonder — a question for further inquiry.

Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw**, or **build** their response.

5 Ws

⌚ 5-10 min

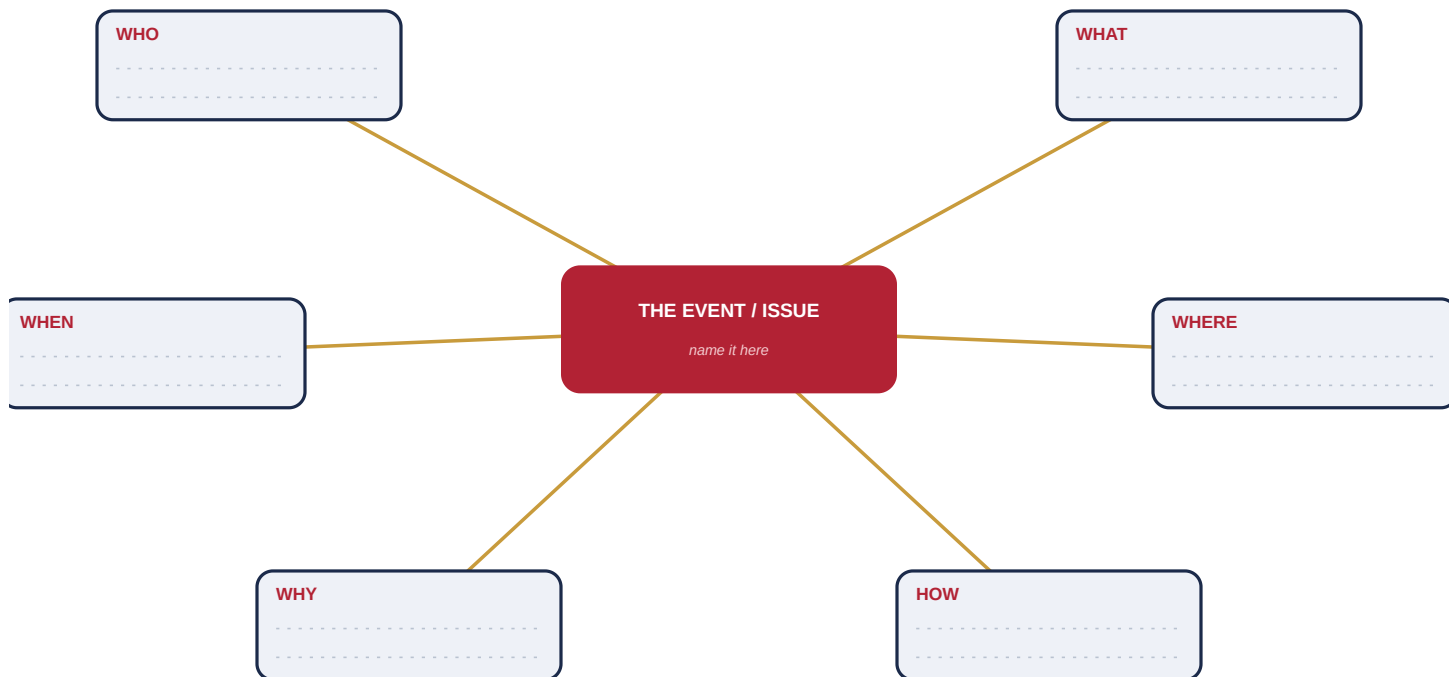
Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

5 Ws

SSP.01

WHEN · WHY Capture the **basics of an event** fast — who, what, when, where, why (and how). *Collecting information from sources is TN Practice SSP.01.*

Name the event or issue in the center, then answer each question around it.



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SCAFFOLD

Assign each question to a partner pair, then combine into one shared chart.

EXTEND

Turn the 'Why' and 'How' answers into a single cause-and-effect sentence.

SHOW IT YOUR WAY

Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw**, or **build** their response.

Problem & Solution

⌚ 15-20 min

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

Problem-Solution

Decision

WHEN · WHY Weigh options against a defined problem and decide with evidence, naming each trade-off. *Devising and defending solutions builds SSP.04.*

State the problem, sketch two possible solutions with their trade-offs, then decide.

THE PROBLEM

WHAT IS THE PROBLEM, EXACTLY?

Option A: _____

THE IDEA

TRADE-OFF / RESULT

Option B: _____

THE IDEA

TRADE-OFF / RESULT

Best solution: _____ — because _____

MAKE IT WORK FOR EVERY STUDENT

UDL · MTSS

SCAFFOLD

Provide one worked solution with its trade-off; students generate the second.

EXTEND

Add a third option and rank all three by which trade-off is easiest to accept.

SHOW IT YOUR WAY

Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw**, or **build** their response.

WHEN · WHY Learn a key term deeply: definition, characteristics, examples, and non-examples — not a definition forgotten by Friday. *Robust vocabulary work is Marzano's six-step method.*

Write the term in the center, then complete all four corners.

DEFINITION (in your words)	CHARACTERISTICS (must-have traits)
TERM write the term	
EXAMPLES	EXAMPLES

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SCAFFOLD
Give the definition; students generate the examples and non-examples.

EXTEND
Write one sentence that uses the term correctly in a new context.

SHOW IT YOUR WAY
Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw**, or **build** their response.

Claim – Evidence – Reasoning

⌚ 20-25 min

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

C-E-R

SSP.04 Argument

WHEN · WHY Turn an opinion into a **defensible argument**: a claim, the evidence for it, and the reasoning that ties them.
Constructing evidence-based arguments is TN Practice SSP.04.

Answer the question with a claim, back it with evidence, then explain your reasoning.

CLAIM — answer the question in one sentence

ONE CLEAR SENTENCE

EVIDENCE — specific facts / quotations that support the claim

QUOTE / FACT 1 ... QUOTE / FACT 2

REASONING — why the evidence proves the claim

HOW DOES THE EVIDENCE PROVE THE CLAIM?
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SCAFFOLD

Provide a claim stem and one piece of evidence; students supply the reasoning.

EXTEND

Add a counter-claim and one sentence explaining why your evidence still wins.

SHOW IT YOUR WAY

Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw**, or **build** their response.

HIPPO — Source Analysis

⌚ 15-20 min

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

HIPPO

SSP.02

WHEN · WHY Give students a historian's routine for **interrogating a source**: context, audience, point of view, purpose, outside information. *Critically examining sources is TN Practice SSP.02.*

Record the source, then work through each element to analyze it.

Source: _____ title · author / creator · date · type

H

HISTORICAL CONTEXT

What was happening when this was made?

I

INTENDED AUDIENCE

Who was meant to see or read it?

P

POINT OF VIEW

Who made it — and how does that shape it?

P

PURPOSE

Why was it made? What did it want to do?

O

OUTSIDE INFORMATION

What do you know that connects to it?

MAKE IT WORK FOR EVERY STUDENT

UDL · MTSS

SCAFFOLD

Model H and I together on a shared source before students do P, P, O.

EXTEND

Use the O row to connect this source to another document you have studied.

SHOW IT YOUR WAY

Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw**, or **build** their response.

Tennessee Connection

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

✓ REPRODUCIBLE

⌚ 10-15 min

★ TENNESSEE CONNECTION

★ TN Connection

Signature Move

WHEN · WHY Connect the **nation** to **Tennessee** — local ties make national civics stick. This is our signature move.
Relevance and connection to students' lives is a UDL engagement principle.

Note the national idea on the left and its Tennessee counterpart on the right, then link them.

NATIONAL

how are they connected?

★ CONNECTS TO

TENNESSEE

How are they linked? _____

Why the local story matters: _____

MAKE IT WORK FOR EVERY STUDENT		
UDL · MTSS		
SCAFFOLD Give the national example; students find the Tennessee counterpart with a provided source.	EXTEND Explain how the Tennessee case is similar to <i>and</i> different from the national one.	SHOW IT YOUR WAY Students may write , say (record), draw , or build their response.

WHEN · WHY Tennessee divides power into three departments, just like the nation. A matrix holds each branch to the same questions, so students see who leads it, what it does, and the Tennessee feature that makes it distinct.
Identifying the structure and functions of government builds TN Practice SSP.01.

For each branch, name who leads it, an agency/chamber/court within it, and one distinctly Tennessee feature.

	LEGISLATIVE General Assembly	EXECUTIVE Governor & agencies	JUDICIAL the courts
Who leads it & its main job			
A chamber, agency, or court inside it			
One Tennessee feature (citizen legislature · Grand Divisions · Tennessee Plan · Chancery/Circuit/Criminal)			
PATTERN		Pattern: How do Tennessee's three branches check and balance one another? _____	

MAKE IT WORK FOR EVERY STUDENT

UDL · MTSS

SCAFFOLD
Give a card set — Governor, General Assembly, Supreme Court, a Chancery/Circuit/Criminal court, a state department — to sort into the three columns before writing.

EXTEND
Explain the 'Tennessee Plan' for choosing appellate judges, and how Chancery, Circuit, and Criminal courts divide the work. Then look up the current Chief Justice from an official source.

SHOW IT YOUR WAY
Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw**, or **build** their response.

WHEN · WHY Tennessee is a unitary state: it creates the local governments beneath it. A matrix compares the three types side by side, then asks students to apply them to their own county and city. *Comparing structures against one yardstick builds TN Practice SSP.02.*

Compare the three types, then apply them to your own community in the last row.

	COUNTY covers all TN	CITY municipality	METRO consolidated city-county
How it is structured (who leads it)			
Services it typically provides			
How it depends on the state (legal · fiscal · operational)			
Which type(s) govern YOUR home? Name your own county / city and its model			
PATTERN		Pattern: Why can no Tennessee county, city, or metro act beyond what the state allows (unitary government · Dillon's Rule)? _____	

MAKE IT WORK FOR EVERY STUDENT

UDL · MTSS

SCAFFOLD
Sort service cards — sheriff, city police, schools, water, zoning, property tax — into County / City / Metro first.

EXTEND
Write the opinion piece: how can an individual best serve their community and take part in the political process at the local, state, and national levels? Defend a claim with examples.

SHOW IT YOUR WAY
Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw**, or **build** their response.

Identify Your Current Officials

⌚ 15-20 min

Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

Lookup · Record from an Official Source

SSP.06 · DOK 1

WHEN · WHY Officials change with every election, so this standard is a look-it-up task. This organizer is a blank record form: using official Tennessee sources, students find and write down who governs them right now — and where they found it. *Locating and verifying current officials builds civic practice SSP.06.*

Use an OFFICIAL source (tn.gov · capitol.tn.gov 'Find My Legislator'). Record each office below; confirm — never guess.

	WHO HOLDS IT NOW current name	MY DISTRICT # from address lookup	OFFICIAL SOURCE I USED where I confirmed it
Governor of Tennessee (statewide)		(statewide)	
My State Senator			
My State Representative			
PATTERN	Governor's top stated priority (from an official source, e.g. the State of the State): _____		

MAKE IT WORK FOR EVERY STUDENT UDL · MTSS

SCAFFOLD

Model one lookup together on the board: enter a sample Tennessee address into the official 'Find My Legislator' tool, then read off the Senate and House districts.

EXTEND

Draft a short, respectful message to one of your legislators about an issue you care about — and explain why naming your specific district helps you be heard.

SHOW IT YOUR WAY

Students may **write**, **say** (record), **draw**, or **build** their response.